

Record the chart result accurately

The smallest line read and any additional letters determine the Snellen entry.

Reading the notation

Result	Record / interpretation
4/5 on 6/15, then 2 on 6/12	6/15+2; the next line is not completed.
4/5 on 6/12, none below	6/12-1; one letter on that line was missed.
6/12	At six metres, reads what normal vision reads at twelve metres.
Distance spectacles available	Measure with distance correction and label the result as aided.

Pinhole adds an optical clue

Test one eye at a time with the fellow eye fully occluded. If acuity is reduced, record the pinhole result as well. A substantial improvement points toward an uncorrected refractive component. Persistent reduction after pinhole warrants assessment for other causes; a favourable pinhole result does not substitute for the remainder of the examination.

Measure very poor vision in order

Failure at one level should lead to the next test, not an assumed final grade.

Below the largest chart letter

Counting fingers: reduce the distance if necessary and record the distance achieved.



If counting fingers fails at 30 cm, assess hand movements at 30 cm.



If hand movements are not detected, test light perception with the fellow eye securely covered.



Record perception of light or no perception of light from reliable repeated responses.

Make the response trustworthy

Use a plain background and unpredictable finger numbers or light presentations. Keep the fellow eye covered so it cannot answer for the tested eye. Counting fingers and hand-movement entries include the test distance; perception of light is a distinct lower level. Repeat unclear responses rather than jumping directly from failed chart reading to no light perception.